Different colour combinations

Grey + red

How it feels

A stone house and a red roof. Red gives grey life and grey gives red calm. Together they look like brick and stone.

When it suits

When you want **strength with calm**.

Specific shades



grey + red
strikingly



graphite + burgundy
deeply



silver + coral
freshly



slate + scarlet
elegantly



dove + brick
earthily

In practice

A grey coat and a red scarf. A grey wall and a red picture.

Watch out

Two strong colours pull against each other. Give one of them **more space**.

Grey + orange

How it feels

Ash and fire. Orange warms grey up and grey calms orange. Together they look modern and friendly.

When it suits

When you want **warmth with distance**.

Specific shades



grey + orange
radiantly



graphite + terracotta
richly



silver + apricot
softly



slate + pumpkin
daringly



dove + rust
subduedly

In practice

A grey sofa with an orange cushion. A grey bag and an orange scarf.

Watch out

Too much orange next to grey shouts. Try to **mute it with something earthier**.

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Grey + yellow

How it feels

Mist and sun. Yellow lights grey up and grey gives yellow calm. Together they look fresh, like an autumn day with a ray of sun.

When it suits

When you want **cheerful restraint**.

Specific shades



grey + yellow
cheerfully



graphite + ochre
golden



silver + butter
springlike



slate + lemon
radiantly



dove + mustard
subduedly

In practice

A grey coat and a yellow scarf. A grey wall and a yellow vase.

Watch out

At equal saturation the colours pull against each other. Keep yellow **as an accent**.

Grey + green

How it feels

Stone and moss. Green and grey are a natural pair. Rock, moss, an olive tree, nobody blinks at that.

When it suits

When you want **a natural and calm impression**.

Specific shades



grey + green
naturally



graphite + bottle green
woodland



silver + mint
freshly



slate + emerald
earthily



dove + sage
quietly

In practice

A green plant on a grey table. Sage and grey in a living room.

Watch out

A sharp green next to a cold grey sounds loud. **Mute** the green.

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Grey + blue

How it feels

Mist over water. Blue cools grey and grey quietens blue. Together they feel calm, but easily cold.

When it suits

When you want **calm and airiness**.

Specific shades



grey + blue
calmly



graphite + dark blue
deeply



silver + sky
airily



slate + cobalt
freshly



dove + denim
soberly

In practice

A blue jumper and grey trousers. A light blue wall and grey furniture.

Watch out

Both are cold. Without warmth the whole can feel **cold**.

Grey + indigo

How it feels

Dusk. Indigo gives grey depth and grey gives indigo light. Together they recall an evening sky.

When it suits

When you want **depth without heaviness**.

Specific shades



grey + indigo
at dusk



graphite + ink
deeply



silver + twilight blue
firmly



slate + ultramarine
dramatically



dove + grey-indigo
soberly

In practice

An indigo coat and a grey scarf. Navy and grey in an office.

Watch out

Dark and dark blend. Add **a light colour**.

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Grey + violet

How it feels

Mist with lavender. Purple gives grey dreaminess and grey gives purple calm. Together they feel quiet and elegant.

When it suits

When you want **softness and depth**.

Specific shades



grey + purple
dreamily



graphite + plum
mysteriously



silver + lavender
deeply



slate + orchid
richly



dove + grey-violet
dustily

In practice

Lavender and dove on cushions. Grey-violet and silver in jewellery.

Watch out

A too cold and veiled whole. Add **a warm colour**.

Grey + pink

How it feels

Stone and peony. Pink softens grey and grey calms pink. Together they feel tasteful, not sweet.

When it suits

When you want **elegance without sweetness**.

Specific shades



grey + pink
soberly



graphite + raspberry
elegantly



silver + powder
lightly



slate + fuchsia
modernly



dove + old rose
quietly

In practice

A grey coat and a pink scarf. A grey wall and an old-rose throw.

Watch out

A cold grey with a sharp pink is **unforgiving**. Try a warmer material.

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Grey + brown

How it feels

Stone and wood. Brown warms grey and grey lightens brown. Together they feel natural and calm.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and stability**.

Specific shades



grey + brown
naturally



graphite + chocolate
calmly



silver + beige
earthily



slate + caramel
soberly



dove + linen
subduedly

In practice

A grey sofa and a wooden table. A grey jumper and brown boots.

Watch out

Two neutral colours can merge. Add **a lively colour**.

Grey + white

How it feels

A clean sheet. White brightens grey and gives it space. Together they feel fresh and calm.

When it suits

When you want **purity and lightness**.

Specific shades



grey + white
cleanly



graphite + ivory
elegantly



silver + snow
freshly



slate + milk
strikingly



dove + bone
gently

In practice

A white kitchen with a grey worktop. A white shirt and grey trousers.

Watch out

Too much white and grey can feel **clinical**. Add wood or linen.

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Grey + black

How it feels

Graphic contrast. Black makes grey a deep colour. Together they look serious and elegant.

When it suits

When you want **expression and elegance**.

Specific shades


grey + black
dramatically


graphite + charcoal
deeply


silver + anthracite
soberly


slate + ink black
elegantly


dove + soot
discreetly

In practice

A black jacket and a grey jumper. A blackboard and grey chalk.

Watch out

Two dark colours tend to be heavy. Add **white or cream**.

Grey + gold

How it feels

Silver and gold. Gold highlights grey and gives it shine. Together they look festive and sober at once.

When it suits

When you want **celebration without heaviness**.

Specific shades


grey + gold
festively


graphite + antique gold
richly


silver + champagne
gently


slate + rich gold
radiantly


dove + matte gold
subduedly

In practice

Gold jewellery on a grey jumper. Grey packaging with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess gold drowns out calm and the space recalls **a shop window**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **warm** grey, add **ochre**, **brown**, **wood** or **cream**.
- When you want to **bring it to life**, add **green**, **yellow** or **pink**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **indigo**, **dark blue** or **black** will help.
- When you want to **emphasise** it, add **gold**, **red** or **white**.

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